



News Release

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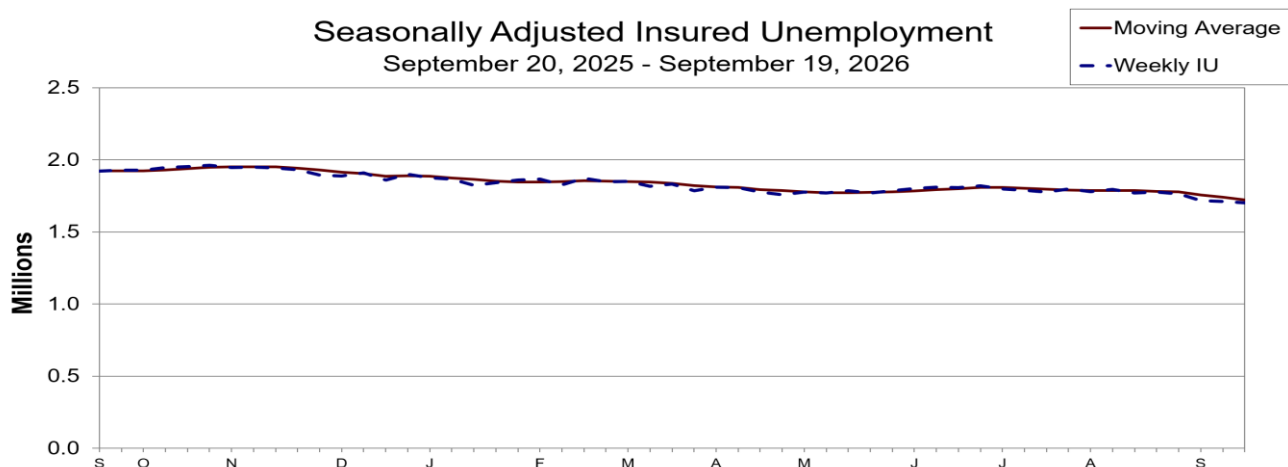
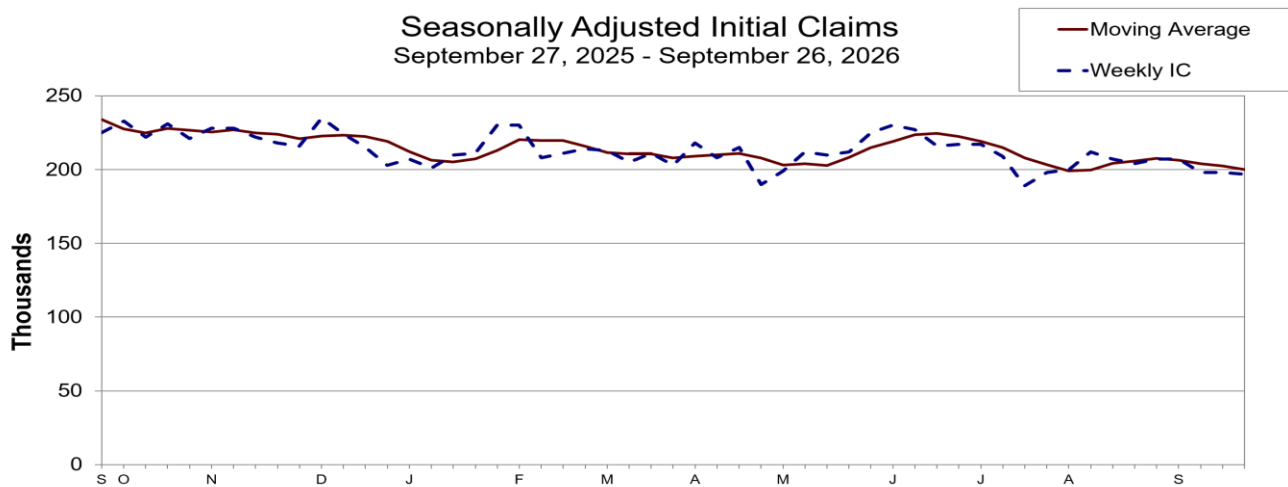
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8:30 A.M. (Eastern) Thursday, October 1, 2026

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE WEEKLY CLAIMS

SEASONALLY ADJUSTED DATA

In the week ending September 26, the advance figure for seasonally adjusted **initial claims** was 197,000, a decrease of 1,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised up by 1,000 from 197,000 to 198,000. The 4-week moving average was 200,000, a decrease of 2,500 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised up by 250 from 202,250 to 202,500.

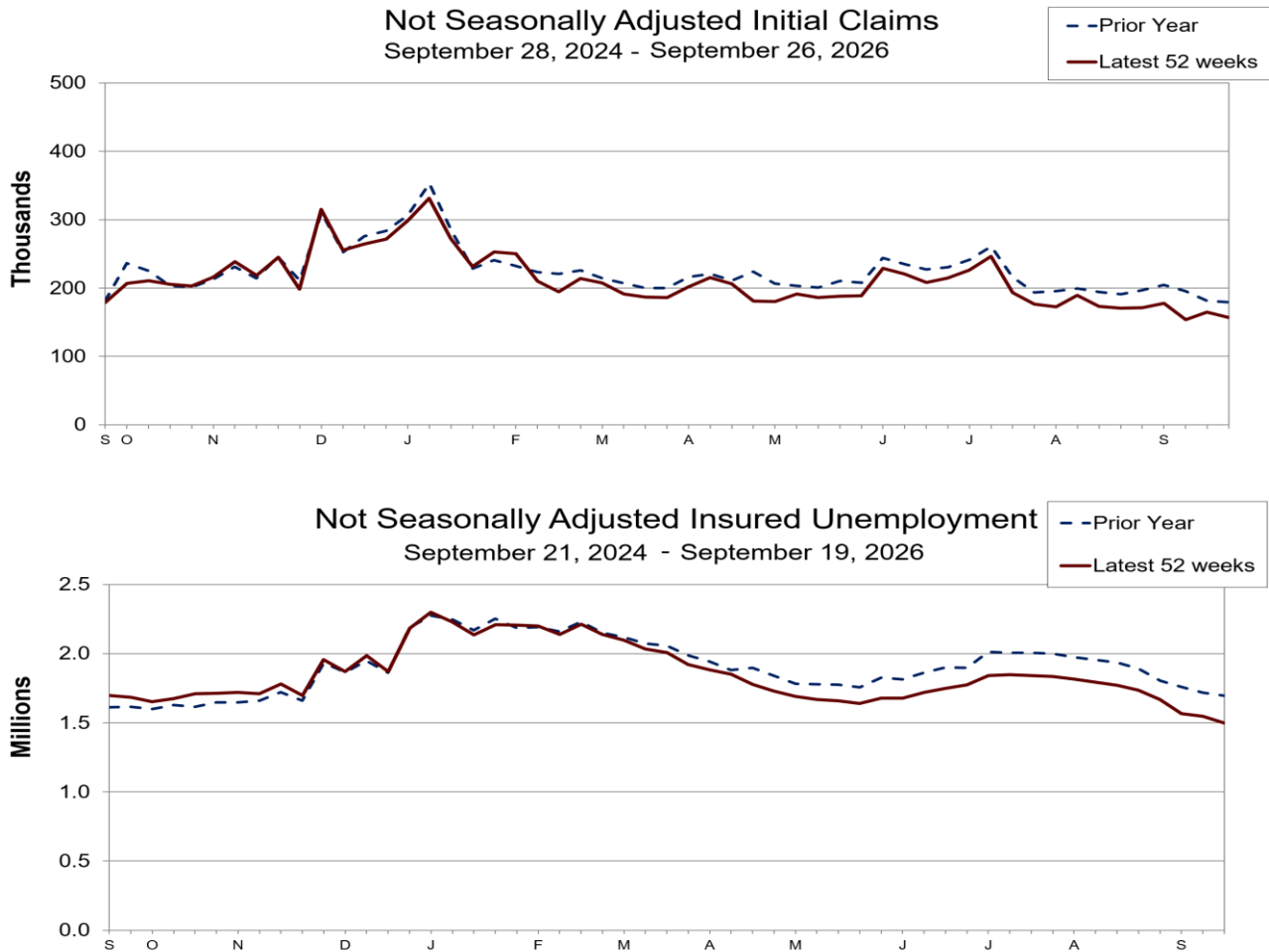
The advance seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment rate** was 1.1 percent for the week ending September 19, unchanged from the previous week's unrevised rate. The advance number for seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment** during the week ending September 19 was 1,701,000, a decrease of 11,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised down by 7,000 from 1,719,000 to 1,712,000. The 4-week moving average was 1,723,750, a decrease of 18,500 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised down by 1,750 from 1,744,000 to 1,742,250.



UNADJUSTED DATA

The advance number of actual initial claims under state programs, unadjusted, totaled 156,738 in the week ending September 26, a decrease of 7,979 (or -4.8 percent) from the previous week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 6,747 (or -4.1 percent) from the previous week. There were 179,162 initial claims in the comparable week in 2025.

The advance unadjusted insured unemployment rate was 1.0 percent during the week ending September 19, unchanged from the prior week. The advance unadjusted level of insured unemployment in state programs totaled 1,498,378, a decrease of 47,267 (or -3.1 percent) from the preceding week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 37,657 (or -2.4 percent) from the previous week. A year earlier the rate was 1.1 percent and the volume was 1,696,023.



The total number of continued weeks claimed for benefits in all programs for the week ending September 12 was 1,567,411, a decrease of 21,222 from the previous week. There were 1,749,873 weekly claims filed for benefits in all programs in the comparable week in 2025.

No state was triggered "on" the Extended Benefits program during the week ending September 12.

Initial claims for UI benefits filed by former Federal civilian employees totaled 369 in the week ending September 19, an increase of 7 from the prior week. There were 379 initial claims filed by newly discharged veterans, an increase of 21 from the preceding week.

There were 5,119 continued weeks claimed filed by former Federal civilian employees the week ending September 12, an increase of 14 from the previous week. Newly discharged veterans claiming benefits totaled 4,834, a decrease of 141 from the prior week.

The highest insured unemployment rates in the week ending September 12 were in New Jersey (2.1), Massachusetts (1.8), Washington (1.8), California (1.7), Puerto Rico (1.7), Nevada (1.6), Oregon (1.6), New York (1.5), Rhode Island (1.5), and Illinois (1.4).

The largest increases in initial claims for the week ending September 19 were in California (+2,352), Hawaii (+1,524), New York (+868), Texas (+768), and Illinois (+738), while the largest decreases were in Massachusetts (-501), Kentucky (-326), Arkansas (-265), Puerto Rico (-124), and Washington (-120).

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE DATA FOR REGULAR STATE PROGRAMS

WEEK ENDING	September 26	September 19	Change	September 12	Prior Year ¹
Initial Claims (SA)	197,000	198,000	-1,000	198,000	225,000
Initial Claims (NSA)	156,738	164,717	-7,979	153,568	179,162
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	200,000	202,500	-2,500	204,000	234,000

WEEK ENDING	September 19	September 12	Change	September 5	Prior Year ¹
Insured Unemployment (SA)	1,701,000	1,712,000	-11,000	1,717,000	1,921,000
Insured Unemployment (NSA)	1,498,378	1,545,645	-47,267	1,565,675	1,696,023
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	1,723,750	1,742,250	-18,500	1,757,000	1,922,250
Insured Unemployment Rate (SA) ²	1.1%	1.1%	0.0	1.1%	1.3%
Insured Unemployment Rate (NSA) ²	1.0%	1.0%	0.0	1.0%	1.1%

INITIAL CLAIMS FILED IN FEDERAL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	September 19	September 12	Change	Prior Year ¹
Federal Employees (UCFE)	369	362	+7	530
Newly Discharged Veterans (UCX)	379	358	+21	355

CONTINUED WEEKS CLAIMED FILED FOR UI BENEFITS IN ALL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	September 12	September 5	Change	Prior Year ¹
Regular State	1,541,854	1,561,565	-19,711	1,712,217
Federal Employees	5,119	5,105	+14	8,223
Newly Discharged Veterans	4,834	4,975	-141	4,657
Extended Benefits ³	10	18	-8	21
State Additional Benefits ⁴	3,243	3,073	+170	2,497
STC / Workshare ⁵	12,351	13,897	-1,546	22,258
TOTAL	1,567,411	1,588,633	-21,222	1,749,873

FOOTNOTES

SA - Seasonally Adjusted Data, NSA - Not Seasonally Adjusted Data Continued weeks claimed represent all weeks of benefits claimed during the week being reported, and do not represent weeks claimed by unique individuals.

1. Prior year is comparable to most recent data.
2. Most recent week used covered employment of 153,732,307 as denominator.
3. Information on the EB program can be found here: [EB Program information](#)
4. Some states maintain additional benefit programs for those claimants who exhaust regular benefits, and when applicable, extended benefits. Information on states that participate, and the extent of benefits paid, can be found starting on page 4-5 of this link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)
5. Information on STC/Worksharing can be found starting on page 4-11 of the following link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)

Advance State Claims - Not Seasonally Adjusted

STATE	Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended September 26			Insured Unemployment For Week Ended September 19		
	Advance	Prior Wk	Change	Advance	Prior Wk	Change
Alabama	1,570	1,813	-243	6,445	6,938	-493
Alaska	554	431	123	3,088	3,032	56
Arizona	2,196	2,343	-147	19,005	22,187	-3,182
Arkansas	940	1,020	-80	4,603	5,177	-574
California	34,642	34,931	-289	307,610	308,957	-1,347
Colorado	2,824	2,891	-67	30,296	28,931	1,365
Connecticut	1,979	2,031	-52	20,316	19,851	465
Delaware	432	469	-37	4,327	4,132	195
District of Columbia	515	541	-26	6,785	7,115	-330
Florida	4,955	5,284	-329	27,290	31,953	-4,663
Georgia	3,385	4,105	-720	22,107	24,194	-2,087
Hawaii	1,758	2,906	-1,148	7,496	6,482	1,014
Idaho	0	578	-578	0	4,041	-4,041
Illinois	5,705	6,264	-559	78,626	81,829	-3,203
Indiana	1,854	2,060	-206	16,976	17,319	-343
Iowa	1,329	1,369	-40	6,272	6,369	-97
Kansas	783	812	-29	6,113	6,221	-108
Kentucky	1,261	1,311	-50	9,241	8,459	782
Louisiana	1,032	1,204	-172	4,731	5,986	-1,255
Maine	359	411	-52	4,034	4,081	-47
Maryland	1,699	1,924	-225	21,131	21,407	-276
Massachusetts	4,014	4,125	-111	62,195	64,941	-2,746
Michigan	4,558	3,824	734	37,327	42,093	-4,766
Minnesota	2,812	2,933	-121	33,084	34,424	-1,340
Mississippi	721	862	-141	5,515	6,116	-601
Missouri	1,949	2,186	-237	14,036	14,318	-282
Montana	495	501	-6	3,483	3,616	-133
Nebraska	453	502	-49	4,442	4,612	-170
Nevada	2,517	2,438	79	24,989	25,960	-971
New Hampshire	231	361	-130	2,675	3,272	-597
New Jersey	7,270	7,522	-252	86,288	90,103	-3,815
New Mexico	658	728	-70	8,715	8,693	22
New York	12,397	12,974	-577	138,882	145,591	-6,709
North Carolina	2,661	2,769	-108	16,427	17,899	-1,472
North Dakota	230	189	41	1,539	1,711	-172
Ohio	4,308	4,440	-132	33,704	34,763	-1,059
Oklahoma	976	1,168	-192	9,315	9,365	-50
Oregon	4,139	3,823	316	31,488	30,373	1,115
Pennsylvania	7,355	7,481	-126	71,369	74,160	-2,791
Puerto Rico	1,354	1,593	-239	15,572	16,027	-455
Rhode Island	521	711	-190	7,404	7,413	-9
South Carolina	1,548	2,084	-536	13,536	14,396	-860
South Dakota	168	163	5	892	916	-24
Tennessee	2,297	2,464	-167	13,709	14,331	-622
Texas	12,296	12,910	-614	133,732	138,164	-4,432
Utah	1,243	1,266	-23	10,103	10,188	-85
Vermont	230	260	-30	1,949	1,833	116
Virgin Islands *	38	57	-19	404	422	-18
Virginia	2,228	2,196	32	21,135	19,422	1,713
Washington	4,535	4,647	-112	67,127	64,910	2,217
West Virginia	507	555	-48	5,021	4,824	197
Wisconsin	2,033	2,043	-10	14,486	14,920	-434
Wyoming	224	244	-20	1,343	1,208	135
US Total	156,738	164,717	-7,979	1,498,378	1,545,645	-47,267

Note: Advance claims are not directly comparable to claims reported in prior weeks. Advance claims are reported by the state liable for paying the unemployment compensation, whereas previous weeks reported claims reflect claimants by state of residence. In addition, claims reported as "workshare equivalent" in the previous week are added to the advance claims as a proxy for the current week's "workshare equivalent" activity.

*Denotes OUI estimate.

Seasonally Adjusted US Weekly UI Claims (in thousands)

Week Ending	Initial Claims	Change from Prior Week	4-Week Average	Insured Unemployment	Change from Prior Week	4-Week Average	IUR
September 20, 2025	219	-14	236.75	1,921	5	1,922.25	1.3
September 27, 2025	225	6	234.00	1,929	8	1,922.75	1.3
October 4, 2025	233	8	227.50	1,928	-1	1,923.50	1.3
October 11, 2025	222	-11	224.75	1,947	19	1,931.25	1.3
October 18, 2025	231	9	227.75	1,953	6	1,939.25	1.3
October 25, 2025	221	-10	226.75	1,962	9	1,947.50	1.3
November 1, 2025	228	7	225.50	1,946	-16	1,952.00	1.3
November 8, 2025	228	0	227.00	1,949	3	1,952.50	1.3
November 15, 2025	222	-6	224.75	1,943	-6	1,950.00	1.3
November 22, 2025	218	-4	224.00	1,932	-11	1,942.50	1.3
November 29, 2025	216	-2	221.00	1,894	-38	1,929.50	1.2
December 6, 2025	235	19	222.75	1,887	-7	1,914.00	1.2
December 13, 2025	224	-11	223.25	1,910	23	1,905.75	1.2
December 20, 2025	215	-9	222.50	1,860	-50	1,887.75	1.2
December 27, 2025	203	-12	219.25	1,900	40	1,889.25	1.2
January 3, 2026	207	4	212.25	1,875	-25	1,886.25	1.2
January 10, 2026	201	-6	206.50	1,865	-10	1,875.00	1.2
January 17, 2026	210	9	205.25	1,823	-42	1,865.75	1.2
January 24, 2026	211	1	207.25	1,842	19	1,851.25	1.2
January 31, 2026	230	19	213.00	1,859	17	1,847.25	1.2
February 7, 2026	230	0	220.25	1,865	6	1,847.25	1.2
February 14, 2026	208	-22	219.75	1,827	-38	1,848.25	1.2
February 21, 2026	211	3	219.75	1,871	44	1,855.50	1.2
February 28, 2026	214	3	215.75	1,847	-24	1,852.50	1.2
March 7, 2026	213	-1	211.50	1,851	4	1,849.00	1.2
March 14, 2026	205	-8	210.75	1,816	-35	1,846.25	1.2
March 21, 2026	211	6	210.75	1,832	16	1,836.50	1.2
March 28, 2026	203	-8	208.00	1,787	-45	1,821.50	1.2
April 4, 2026	218	15	209.25	1,809	22	1,811.00	1.2
April 11, 2026	208	-10	210.00	1,808	-1	1,809.00	1.2
April 18, 2026	215	7	211.00	1,776	-32	1,795.00	1.2
April 25, 2026	190	-25	207.75	1,758	-18	1,787.75	1.1
May 2, 2026	199	9	203.00	1,776	18	1,779.50	1.2
May 9, 2026	212	13	204.00	1,771	-5	1,770.25	1.2
May 16, 2026	210	-2	202.75	1,785	14	1,772.50	1.2
May 23, 2026	212	2	208.25	1,771	-14	1,775.75	1.2
May 30, 2026	225	13	214.75	1,786	15	1,778.25	1.2
June 6, 2026	230	5	219.25	1,800	14	1,785.50	1.2
June 13, 2026	227	-3	223.50	1,812	12	1,792.25	1.2
June 20, 2026	216	-11	224.50	1,806	-6	1,801.00	1.2
June 27, 2026	217	1	222.50	1,821	15	1,809.75	1.2
July 4, 2026	217	0	219.25	1,798	-23	1,809.25	1.2
July 11, 2026	209	-8	214.75	1,789	-9	1,803.50	1.2
July 18, 2026	189	-20	208.00	1,777	-12	1,796.25	1.2
July 25, 2026	198	9	203.25	1,799	22	1,790.75	1.2
August 1, 2026	200	2	199.00	1,781	-18	1,786.50	1.2
August 8, 2026	212	12	199.75	1,796	15	1,788.25	1.2
August 15, 2026	207	-5	204.25	1,771	-25	1,786.75	1.2
August 22, 2026	204	-3	205.75	1,775	4	1,780.75	1.2
August 29, 2026	207	3	207.50	1,765	-10	1,776.75	1.1
September 5, 2026	207	0	206.25	1,717	-48	1,757.00	1.1
September 12, 2026	198	-9	204.00	1,712	-5	1,742.25	1.1
September 19, 2026	198	0	202.50	1,701	-11	1,723.75	1.1
September 26, 2026	197	-1	200.00				

INITIAL CLAIMS FILED DURING WEEK ENDED SEPTEMBER 19						INSURED UNEMPLOYMENT FOR WEEK ENDED SEPTEMBER 12						
STATE NAME	STATE	CHANGE FROM		UCFE ¹	UCX ¹	STATE	(%) ²	CHANGE FROM		UCFE ¹	UCX ¹	TOTAL INSURED UNEMPLOYMENT
		LAST WEEK	YEAR AGO					LAST WEEK	YEAR AGO			
Alabama	1,813	460	-88	4	6	6,938	0.3	-116	-1,992	17	13	6,968
Alaska	431	59	-25	1	1	3,032	1.0	31	-429	26	5	3,063
Arizona	2,343	8	-271	4	4	22,187	0.7	-152	-5,698	56	30	22,273
Arkansas	1,020	-265	-153	1	2	5,177	0.4	-7	-1,758	10	1	5,188
California	34,931	2,352	-2,482	85	89	308,957	1.7	6,907	-49,517	774	1,203	310,934
Colorado	2,891	379	205	3	12	28,931	1.0	-227	-763	100	207	29,238
Connecticut	2,031	72	-554	2	1	19,851	1.2	-374	-11,956	45	24	19,920
Delaware	469	70	229	0	2	4,132	0.9	-137	-559	8	5	4,145
District of Columbia	541	47	-188	20	0	7,115	1.3	-47	-2,655	386	4	7,505
Florida	5,284	271	-463	11	25	31,953	0.3	1,299	-2,789	80	78	32,111
Georgia	4,105	363	-22	29	15	24,194	0.5	386	-2,673	134	101	24,429
Hawaii	2,906	1,524	1,959	3	8	6,482	1.1	647	909	34	55	6,571
Idaho	578	38	-108	2	3	4,041	0.5	4	-661	6	12	4,059
Illinois	6,264	738	-3,353	6	7	81,829	1.4	1,990	-8,511	306	94	82,229
Indiana	2,060	167	-392	1	0	17,319	0.5	44	-2,472	23	15	17,357
Iowa	1,369	60	182	2	0	6,369	0.4	53	-745	10	4	6,383
Kansas	812	70	-174	0	0	6,221	0.4	-91	-1,168	14	19	6,254
Kentucky	1,311	-326	-28	1	0	8,459	0.4	-752	-1,255	30	4	8,493
Louisiana	1,204	55	-281	1	1	5,986	0.3	-246	-2,603	27	9	6,022
Maine	411	72	-9	1	1	4,081	0.6	-18	-630	12	11	4,104
Maryland	1,924	152	-334	28	3	21,407	0.8	-198	-6,172	300	62	21,769
Massachusetts	4,125	-501	267	0	6	64,941	1.8	-1,550	-2,648	187	140	65,268
Michigan	3,824	191	-384	1	5	42,093	1.0	1,822	-3,801	68	48	42,209
Minnesota	2,933	63	-84	0	2	34,424	1.2	-7,341	-922	58	51	34,533
Mississippi	862	58	44	1	1	6,116	0.5	9	-190	47	7	6,170
Missouri	2,186	371	8	6	3	14,318	0.5	-283	-1,875	64	11	14,393
Montana	501	207	19	2	0	3,616	0.7	19	49	26	7	3,649
Nebraska	502	46	-62	1	0	4,612	0.5	46	-64	10	6	4,628
Nevada	2,438	233	-86	2	2	25,960	1.6	-274	306	40	79	26,079
New Hampshire	361	97	-1	0	1	3,272	0.5	-79	-408	3	1	3,276
New Jersey	7,522	710	-1,179	22	30	90,103	2.1	-8,874	-3,158	204	220	90,527
New Mexico	728	105	64	7	1	8,693	1.0	-25	-946	53	21	8,767
New York	12,974	868	628	11	15	145,591	1.5	-13,473	4,676	300	256	146,147
North Carolina	2,769	160	-543	2	0	17,899	0.4	226	-2,836	61	92	18,052
North Dakota	189	29	-43	0	0	1,711	0.4	-60	-56	8	5	1,724
Ohio	4,440	419	71	5	4	34,763	0.6	717	-7,738	57	68	34,888
Oklahoma	1,168	179	-176	6	4	9,365	0.6	-63	-1,390	27	32	9,424
Oregon	3,823	136	213	3	3	30,373	1.6	-2,369	-394	65	56	30,494
Pennsylvania	7,481	259	-398	17	14	74,160	1.2	-1,936	-10,918	290	111	74,561
Puerto Rico	1,593	-124	328	8	6	16,027	1.7	-1,354	-1,453	119	46	16,192
Rhode Island	711	125	26	1	1	7,413	1.5	-405	-1,073	29	17	7,459
South Carolina	2,084	26	75	5	5	14,396	0.6	-76	120	43	46	14,485
South Dakota	163	31	1	0	0	916	0.2	3	-139	19	1	936
Tennessee	2,464	-94	-525	5	2	14,331	0.4	-3	-1,403	45	29	14,405
Texas	12,910	768	-7,313	40	65	138,164	1.0	6,107	-22,718	451	949	139,564
Utah	1,266	190	105	6	5	10,188	0.6	-76	-1,328	53	20	10,261
Vermont	260	30	74	0	0	1,833	0.6	7	49	9	3	1,845
Virgin Islands	57	3	-13	0	0	422	1.2	8	90	0	2	424
Virginia	2,196	54	-102	3	7	19,422	0.5	-27	-978	135	115	19,672
Washington	4,647	-120	-446	4	14	64,910	1.8	457	-4,411	172	417	65,499
West Virginia	555	95	-89	2	3	4,824	0.7	1	-1,085	30	8	4,862
Wisconsin	2,043	99	-404	2	0	14,920	0.5	-117	-2,156	43	12	14,975
Wyoming	244	70	0	2	0	1,208	0.4	-63	-278	5	2	1,215
Totals	164,717	11,149	-16,275	369	379	1,545,645	1.0	-20,030	-173,173	5,119	4,834	1,555,598

Figures appearing in columns showing over-the-week changes reflect all revisions in data for prior week submitted by state agencies.

1. The Unemployment Compensation program for Federal Employees (UCFE) and the Unemployment Compensation for Ex-servicemembers (UCX) exclude claims filed jointly under other programs to avoid duplication.
2. Rate is not seasonally adjusted. The source of U.S. total covered employment is BLS.

UNADJUSTED INITIAL CLAIMS FOR WEEK ENDED SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

STATES WITH AN INCREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
CA	+2,352	No comment.
HI	+1,524	No comment.

STATES WITH A DECREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
None		

TECHNICAL NOTES

This news release presents the weekly unemployment insurance (UI) claims reported by each state's unemployment insurance program offices. These claims may be used for monitoring workload volume, assessing state program operations and for assessing labor market conditions. States initially report claims directly taken by the state liable for the benefit payments, regardless of where the claimant who filed the claim resided. These are the basis for the advance initial claims and continued claims reported each week. These data come from ETA 538, Advance Weekly Initial and Continued Claims Report. The following week initial claims and continued claims are revised based on a second reporting by states that reflect the claimants by state of residence. These data come from the ETA 539, Weekly Claims and Extended Benefits Trigger Data Report.

A. Initial Claims

An initial claim is a claim filed by an unemployed individual after a separation from an employer. The claimant requests a determination of basic eligibility for the UI program. When an initial claim is filed with a state, certain programmatic activities take place and these result in activity counts including the count of initial claims. The count of U.S. initial claims for unemployment insurance is a leading economic indicator because it is an indication of emerging labor market conditions in the country. However, these are weekly administrative data which are difficult to seasonally adjust, making the series subject to some volatility.

B. Continued Weeks Claimed

A person who has already filed an initial claim and who has experienced a week of unemployment then files a continued claim to claim benefits for that week of unemployment. On a weekly basis, continued claims are also referred to as insured unemployment, as continued claims reflect a good approximation of the current number of insured unemployed workers filing for UI benefits. The count of U.S. continued weeks claimed is also a good indicator of labor market conditions. While continued claims are not a leading indicator (they roughly coincide with economic cycles at their peaks and lag at cycle troughs), they provide confirming evidence of the direction of the U.S. economy.

C. Seasonal Adjustments and Annual Revisions

Over the course of a year, the weekly changes in the levels of initial claims and continued claims undergo regularly occurring fluctuations. These fluctuations may result from seasonal changes in weather, major holidays, the opening and closing of schools, or other similar events. Because these seasonal events follow a more or less regular pattern each year, their influence on the level of a series can be tempered by adjusting for regular seasonal variation. These adjustments make trend and cycle developments easier to spot. At the beginning of each calendar year, the Bureau of Labor Statistics provides the Employment and Training Administration (ETA) with a set of seasonal factors to apply to the unadjusted data during that year. Concurrent with the implementation and release of the new seasonal factors, ETA incorporates revisions to the UI claims historical series caused by updates to the unadjusted data. For further questions on the seasonal adjustment methodology, please see the [official release page for the UI claims seasonal adjustment factors](#) or contact BLS directly through the [Local Area Unemployment Statistics web contact form](#).

[Weekly Claims Archives](#) [Weekly Claims Data](#)

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Washington, D.C. 20210
Release Number: USDL 26-1543-NAT

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